

Brad

The word retirement is so loaded with negative connotations of either sitting around watching TV or sipping umbrella drinks and watching the world go by that I choose not to focus so much on the early retirement aspect of the FIRE acronym and instead focus mainly on FI.

What FI means to me is an entire world of possibilities and the ability to spend my most precious resource—my time—as I see fit. Everyone I know who has reached FI is doing more now in “retirement” than they were during their working years.

And this shouldn't surprise you! They have time, resources and the mental space to focus on what's important to them, how they can impact the world and who and what they want to spend time with and on. That's a marvelously liberating feeling and the pursuit of FI gives you the space to think about these deep and complex topics.

Brad's ideas about FI bring me back to the quote Tanja Hester of the blog *Our Next Life* shared with Brad and Jonathan: “We are some of the luckiest people in human history because we get to do the things we're excited about, that get us out of bed in the morning.”